

KEY

- Barn swallow range (breeding and resident)
- Barn swallow range (nonbreeding)
- North American migration
- European and Western Asian migration
- Central and East Asian migration

Wide bill

The bill is short and flat, but can open wide to scoop up insects in flight, or collect mud to make nests.

Nesting

Many barn swallows attach their mud nests to the walls of buildings such as houses or barns, hence their name. They often line their nests with grasses or feathers, the whole construction taking about ten days to complete.

Western Asia

To the east, the barn swallow's range extends across Central Asia and Russia. Most of these birds will overwinter in southern Asia.

Forked tail

For controlled flight, the long tail spreads wide to help the barn swallow slow down.



ASIA

India

Most barn swallows seen in India are winter visitors only, but further north of this country—and in a few other warmer parts of the world—they may be resident all year.

Eastern Asia

In this part of the world, swallows breed from the Himalayas to Japan. The birds here have creamy-white underparts, but those in far-eastern Siberia have reddish underparts, like those in the Americas.

Hunting for flies

Barn swallows use their long, pointed wings to maneuver themselves in flight. Flying up to 25 mph (40 kph), these acrobatic birds can turn quickly to snap up insects with a wide open beak.

Australia

Barn swallows breeding in eastern Asia typically overwinter in Southeast Asia, but during the twentieth century started migrating further into Australia.

AUSTRALIA

**THESE EXPERT NAVIGATORS
CAN COVER MORE THAN 200 MILES
(320 KM) IN A SINGLE DAY**

